

original
crochet design by aoibhe ni

MACHA

A luxurious, squishy braid sets this shawl apart as a winter must have. Battle the cold months like a fierce, Celtic Queen.

Difficulty: Intermediate

Handy Skills:

Tunisian-Lace Basics,
including short rows and reverse short rows.

Recommended Hook Size:

5.5 mm hook (or size required to achieve tension)

Yarn: approx 900 m / 984 yards

Wingspan: 165 cm / 65 in wide.

Tension: Using a 5.5 mm hook,
16 x L18tr = 10 cm / 4 in

Notions:

- darning needle for weaving in ends.
- 1 x long blocking wire (approx 225 mm)
- 6 x short blocking wires (approx 50 cm each)
(see end of pattern for blocking wire alternatives)

Abbreviations:

ch	chain
sc	single crochet
YO	Yarn Over Hook
L5tr	Linked 5-uple treble
SR	Short Row
RSR	Reverse Short Row
[]	all sts written within []'s are worked in the same stitch space.
**	all sts within ** are to be repeated, in sequence, the number of times indicated.

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

If this is your first time working up a tunisian-lace shawl, I would suggest, before starting into the shawl, trying a little practise piece using smaller, linked 2-uple treble sts.

First, let's make a small piece of traditional crochet to work on:

Make 11 chains,
sc into 2nd ch from hook, and sc to end. This will give you a foundation to work your practise piece on.

Here's how to start the row of linked 2-uple trebles (L2tr):

Chain 3, (this is your truning chain)
Locate the 2nd chain from hook on the turning chain,
Insert hook, YO, pull a loop through,
Repeat process for 3rd chain from hook.
Then, insert hook into closest available stitch space, YO, pull a loop through fabric.

You should have accumulated 4 loops on your hook.

TRY THIS OUT

YO, pull through 2 loops, repeatedly until Right with one loop
(1st first linked-stitch completed).

Second & every subsequent linked-stitch:
The previous stitch will have two, parallel, horizontal lines up its length.

Insert hook into the closest horizontal line,
YO and pull a loop through.
Repeat for the other horizontal line.

Then, insert hook into the closest available stitch space, YO, pull a loop through fabric.
YO, pull through 2 loops, repeatedly until Right with one loop

Notes on working larger linked stitches:

Work similarly to a linked-2-uple treble (explained above), but begin with the number of chains specified in the pattern. This will give more "yo and pull through"s, and will result in a taller stitch, with more horizontal lines up its length.

# of Horizontal Lines	Chains at Beginning of Row (1st ch is Right unused)	Stitch Name	Abbreviation
1	2	Linked 1-uple treble	L1tr
2	3	Linked 2-uple treble	L2tr
5	6	Linked 5-uple treble	L5tr
etc...			

HOW TO GUIDE

Short Row (SR)

Downward Pass:

As with a regular Linked Stitch, pick up number of loops indicated in stitch (ie, SR3. Pick up Three loops) on the downward pass of st.

DO NOT WORK INTO BASE.

Upward Pass:

YO and pull through 2 loops repeat until only one loop remains on hook.

Reverse Short Row (RSR)

Downward Pass:

All Reverse short rows commence with a complete downward pass.

ie. pick up loops in all available horizontal lines, work hook into chain at base, YO, draw up a loop.

Upward Pass:

It is on the Upward Pass that the intended stitch is made.

YO and pull through 1 loop
(base chain made for next st)

Then *YO and pull through 2 loops* number of times indicated in stitch name (ie. RSR3, *YO and pull through 2 loops* three times in total)

Your Reverse short row is complete, even though you will be left with a number of loops on your hook.

Do not work any further up and do not remove any more sts from hook.

If you look carefully, you will notice that you have made a short row that begins at the *base* of your work and travels part of the way *up* (instead of making a short row that starts at the *top* of your work and travelling part of the way *down*) That is why we call it a *Reverse Short Row*.

For the next st, whatever it may be, work from the point you are at and work whatever is left of the downward pass fully, i.e. picking up loops in any horizontal lines available, and into chain at base of work.

Then, complete the upward pass as indicated in pattern.

Left TURN:

1 L5tr,
1 SR2, 1 SR 3, 1 SR 4, 1 SR5,
1 L5tr, 1 SR3, 1 L5tr,
1 SR5, 1 SR4, 1 SR 3, 1 SR 2
1 L5tr

Right TURN:

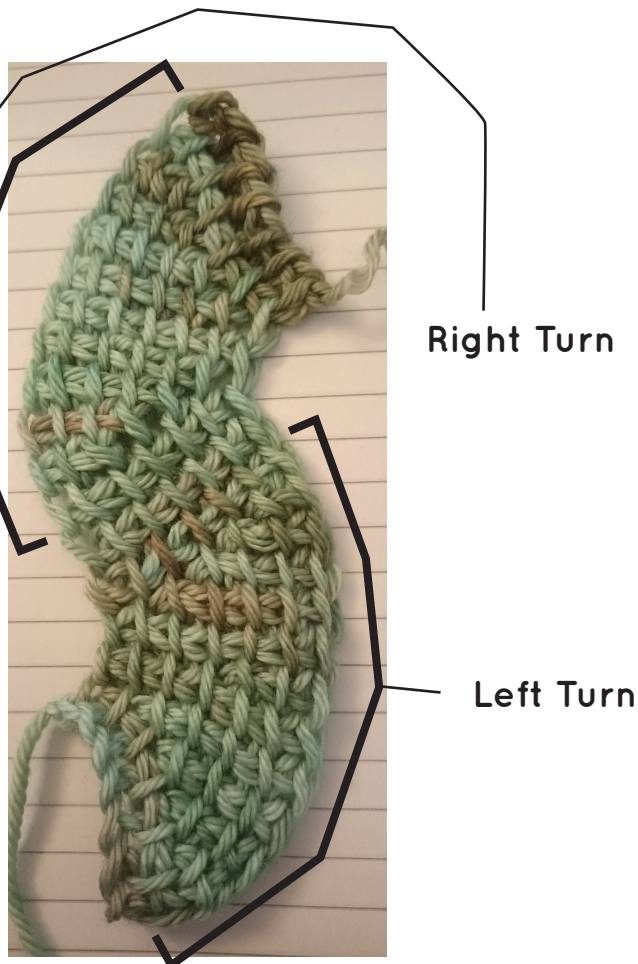
1 L5tr,
1 RSR2, 1 RSR3, 1 RSR4, 1 RSR5,
1 L5tr,
1 RSR5, 1 RSR 4, 1 RSR3, 1 RSR2
1 L5tr.

It might be worthwhile to run a small practise piece first before beginning in earnest. To do this, we will make one left turn, then one right turn.

Note: all Linked stitches in Braided Section and Practise Piece are FOUNDATION sts. See "How To Guide" at end of pattern for a full explanation of how these are done.

Practise Piece Begins:
Make 7 chains.

Strand Foundation:
1 LEFT turn, 1 L5tr, 1 RIGHT Turn.



Pattern Begins:

Note: See "How To Guide" for explanations of both Left TURN and Right TURN portions of pattern.

Strand One:

Make 7 chains.

Strand Foundation:
3 L5tr,
1 SR2, 1 SR 3, 1 SR 4, 1 SR5,
1 L5tr,

Then,
10 L5tr, 1 Right Turn, 10 L5tr, 1 Left Turn Repeat 10 times
Then, 10 L5tr, 1 RSR2, 1 RSR3, 1 RSR4, 1 RSR5, 1 L5tr.

Finish Strand One by working 5 sc sts along length of last L5tr completed, and an additional 1 sc into base of previously worked st.
Bind Off.

Note: It would be helpful later on to add a tag to each strand as you complete it, so you don't forget which one is which.

Strand Two:

Make 7 chains.

Strand Foundation:
1 L5tr,
1 SR2, 1 SR 3, 1 SR 4, 1 SR5,
5 L5tr,

Then,
*1 Right Turn, 10 L5tr, 1 Left Turn, 10

L5tr,* Repeat 10 times

Then, 1 Right Turn, 5 L5tr, 1 SR2, 1 SR3, 1 SR4, 1 SR5, 1 L5tr.

Finish Strand Two by working 5 sc sts along length of last L5tr completed, and an additional 1 sc into base of previously worked st. Bind Off.

Strand Three:

Make 7 chains.

Strand Foundation:

1 L5tr,
1 RSR2, 1 RSR 3, 1 RSR 4, 1 RSR5,

Then,
10 L5tr, 1 Left Turn, 10 L5tr, 1 Right Turn, Repeat 10 times

Then, 10 L5tr, 1 SR2, 1 SR3, 1 SR4, 1 SR5, 3 L5tr.

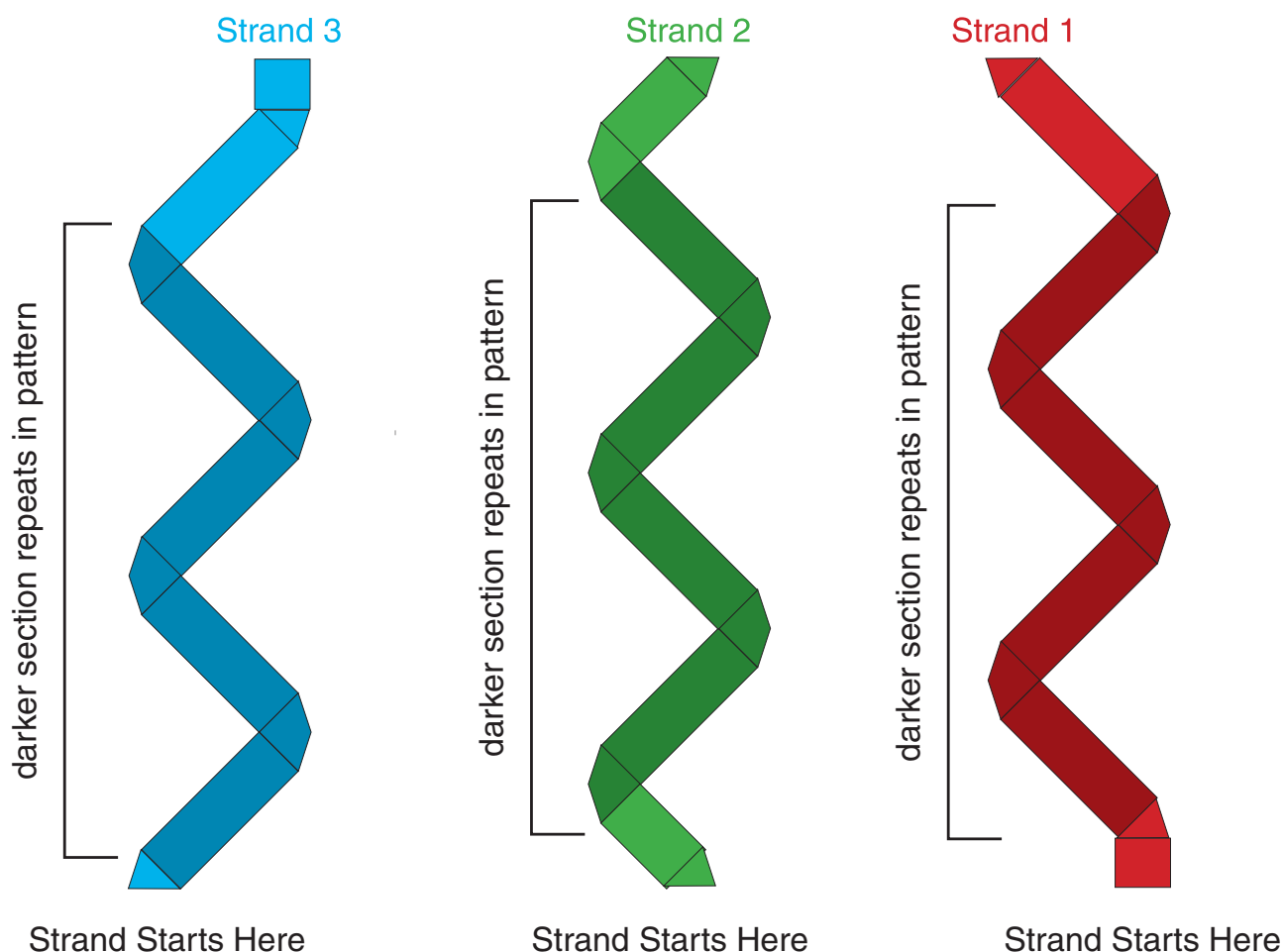
Finish Strand Three by working 5 sc sts along length of last L5tr completed, then Bind Off.

Constructing the plaited section.

Place all three strands with the beginning row of each strand closest to you in the order shown in fig.1.

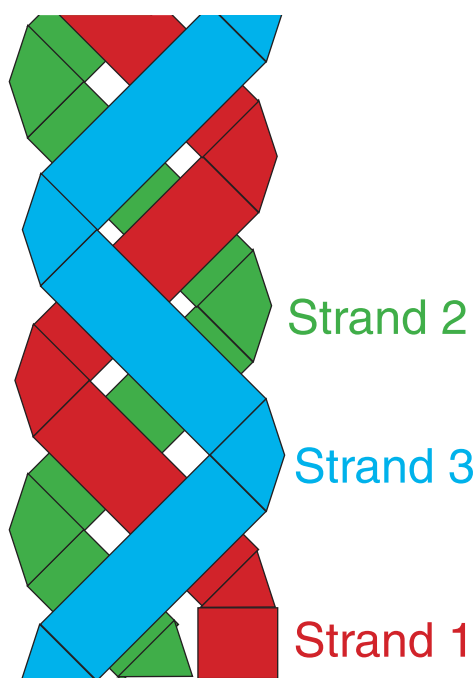
Note: It may be helpful to roll each strand into a ball with some of the strand left free.

Place Strand Two directly to the left of Strand One.





Then take Strand Three and rest it directly to the left of Strand Two.



Attach yarn to the corner of Strand 1 and work 6 sc across its chains, then move on to Strand B and repeat the same. Work 6 sc sts across the chains of Strand C, adding one additional sc to the last available space of Strand C. - 19 sts.

Add a stitch marker into live loop, and plait strands together.

Working body of Shawl.

Set Up:

Rotate plait 90o with the wrong sides of the plaited section still facing you.

Row 1.

Then work sc sts along the successive curves that make up the edge of the plait, putting 1 sc per stitch space thus:

Curve 1: 6 sc

Curve 2-32: 11 sc each.

Note: the 11 scs for each curve will fit best into the sts made by each Right Turn.

Curve 33 (Final Curve): 6 sc, 9 ch, turn (353 sts)

Row 2. 5 L8tr, *Chart A* 31 times, Chart B, 1 ch, turn.

Row 3. 5 sc, dc2tog, *9 sc, dc2tog* 31 times, 5 sc, 9 ch, turn (321 sts)

Row 4. 4 L8tr, *Chart C* 31 times, Chart D, 1 ch, turn.

Row 5. 5 sc, dc2tog, *8 sc, dc2tog* 31 times, 4 sc, 9 ch, turn (289 sts)

Row 6. 3 L8tr, *Chart E* 31 times, Chart F, 1 ch, turn.

Row 7. sc to end of row.

Finish Row 7 by rotating work 90o and working down side of shawl body section as follows, *1 sc into edge of each sc row & 8 sc sts along length of each L8tr row* 3 times, then continue on down open side of plait, adding 6 sc

sts to end of each plait strand.

Row 8. 1 sc into same st space as last sc of Row 7. Rotate work 90° so you're able to work along the plaited section once more.

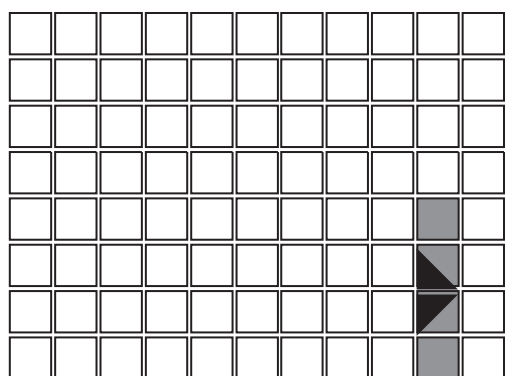
Secure bottom edge of plait by adding

1 sc to first 8 sts of curve 1, 13 sts to the next 35 curves, and 8 sts into final curve, ending at the edge of plait. (471 sts)

Bind off, weave in ends, and block gently.

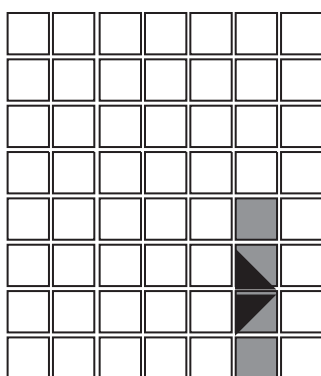


Chart A



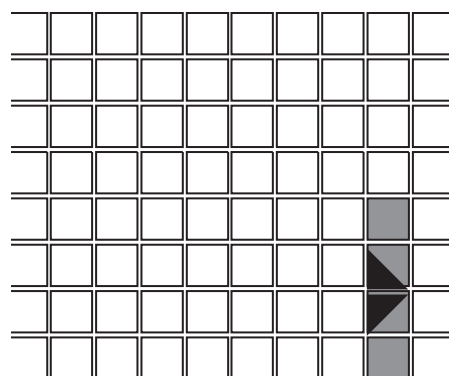
← direction of work

Chart B



← direction of work

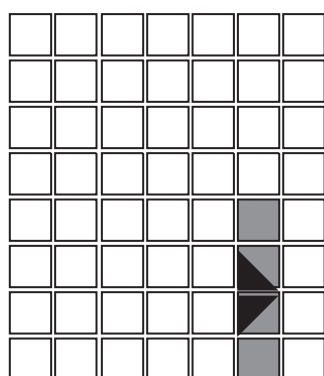
Chart C



← direction of work

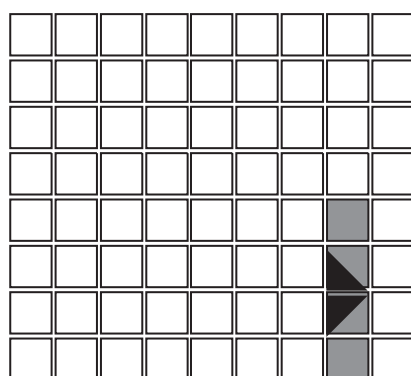
top to bottom of stitch
↓

Chart D



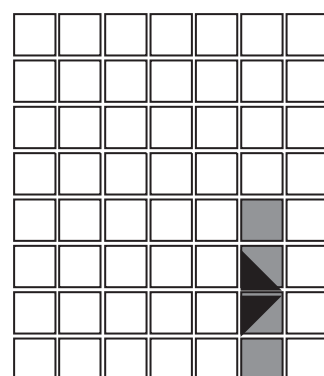
← direction of work

Chart E



← direction of work

Chart F



← direction of work

top to bottom of stitch
↓

Key:

□ Regular Space

▴ Yarn Over (Tunisian Eyelet)

▴ Double Yarn Over
(Large Tunisian Eyelet)

▣ Tunisian Decrease
(2 lines together)

▣ "yo & pull through" into base

Large Tunisian Eyelet:

Column 2: DEC, YO, YO, DEC.

Column 3: Upon reaching the first YO of column 2, put the hook through the eyelet itself, YO and draw a loop up through that.

The second YO will be easier to find so work that as usual; (If you have difficulty locating it, it's in the top left corner of the eyelet itself, like a little spiderweb in the corner of a window frame) Hook into that, YO and draw a loop through. Carry on with remainder of downward pass, and complete upward pass as usual.